Labor, employer and industry research

Using Data to Drive Business Performance

Research and proposal review · October 2026

What we researched

A 2026 analysis of 855 relevant U.S. data analyst job postings, U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics projections, and the World Economic Forum employer survey.

What employers ask for

We looked at what employers ask for in the skills this book teaches.

52.9% of job postings	**U.S. data analyst job postings that ask for SQL** Of 855 postings analyzed. Python appears in 31.2%, Power BI in 29.0% and Tableau in 26.2%.Source: 365 Data Science [9]
+35% growth, 2025 to 2035	**Projected growth in data scientist jobs** Against 3% for all occupations. Median pay: $120,230 a year.Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics [10]
+9% growth, 2025 to 2035	**Projected growth in database architect jobs** Median pay: $139,500 a year.Source: U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics [11]
About two-thirds of employers worldwide	**Plan to hire for AI skills** AI and big data are the fastest-growing skills employers report.Source: World Economic Forum [12]
SQL	52.9%
Python	31.2%
Power BI	29.0%
Tableau	26.2%

Share of 855 U.S. data analyst job postings that list each skill.

Evidence	Finding	Courseware implication
BLS: data scientists, 2025-35	**35% projected growth** , compared with 3% for all occupations; about **24,800 openings annually** . [L1]	Connect data preparation and queries to interpretation, communication, and decisions.
BLS: database architects / administrators, 2025-35	Architects: **9%** growth. Administrators: **0%** . Combined: about **7,300 openings annually** . [L2]	Retain modeling, quality, permissions, backup, and system judgment alongside analytics.
WEF: Future of Jobs Report 2025	Survey of **1,000+ employers** , representing **14 million+ workers** across **55 economies** ; roughly **7 in 10** identify analytical thinking as essential. [L3]	Require students to explain a result, test its reliability, and justify an action.
WEF: skills outlook to 2030	AI and big data lead the skills employers expect to grow fastest. [L3]	Integrate responsible AI use, verification, data provenance, and limits across the learning experience.

Main conclusion SQL, reporting and judgment belong together. Students need to produce a result, establish that it is reliable, and communicate what an organization should do with it.

Job-posting shares describe this sample, not all U.S. hiring. BLS openings include replacement hiring. Global employer expectations are distinct from U.S. job-posting requirements.

References

Market, employment and curriculum references

References

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• Fustos, J., et al. (2017). Do students get enough information systems education in the business core? Study of 61 business schools. Link

• Data USA. (2026). Management information systems and services (IPEDS completions, 2024). Link

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• Zheng, Y., Hameed, T., Lavoie, R., & Sendall, P. (2021). An overview of current business analytics programs across US AACSB schools. Issues in Information Systems, 22(2), 306-317. Link

• Yang, S. C. (2023). The master's program in information systems: A survey of core curricula in AACSB-accredited business schools in the United States. Journal of Information Systems Education, 34(4), 430-440. Link

• Data USA. (2026). Accounting (IPEDS completions, 2024). Link

• AACSB International. (2026, September). Accreditation announcement, September 2026. Link

• 365 Data Science. (2026). The data analyst job market in 2026: Research on 1,000 job postings. Link

• U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. (2026). Occupational Outlook Handbook: Data scientists. Link

• U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics. (2026). Occupational Outlook Handbook: Database administrators and architects. Link

• World Economic Forum. (2025). The Future of Jobs Report 2025. Link

• Cengage. Concepts of Database Management, 10th edition (2021). Link

Manuscript, textbook, platform and original-cover references

[S1]

Collected syllabus archive and manifest ↗

63 documents; 31 institutions; archived October 1, 2026. Mixed course levels and dates.

[S2]

Database-platform evidence model and report ↗

October 17, 2026 audit. Role-coded platform evidence, 54 selected course families; counts recalculated for this package.

[S3]

Curriculum audit ↗

October 1, 2026 document-level topic summaries and original-source references; used as a discovery aid and checked against archived course text.

[S4]

Textbook adoption and contents audit ↗

October 10, 2026 report: 60 named books/course texts. Historical school-level mentions, not market shares. Broader contents catalogue retained as prior research.

[S5]

Stabilized 14-chapter proposal ↗

Earlier synthesis, stored in the outline-comparison folder. This package proposes a refinement; it does not replace the manuscript outline.

[S6]

Current book repository ↗

Read-only inspection of main, commit 92d7a6ea04b96b67ef983aa22d054ab0bb9ad046; current chapter activation metadata checked.

[S7]

Inactive book-2027 candidate ↗

16-chapter migration candidate with separate core/extension routes. Its README explicitly states that it is inactive and is not published by the reader.

[S8]

Dima Publishing design and book description ↗

Publisher design reference and earlier public description. Cover for this revision comes from the current book website instead; see C1.

[S9]

Brightlab evaluation design document ↗

Prototype description, not validation of fairness, reliability, costs or deployability. Contradictory partial-credit claims require resolution.

[P1]

Cengage: Database Systems, 14th edition ↗

Coronel and Morris. Uploaded copy supplies the historical chapter sequence; official product page documents interactive MySQL labs and other MindTap resources.

[P2]

Cengage: Database Systems, 15th edition ↗

Coronel and Morris. Official current listing checked October 25, 2026; detailed sequence is retained from the earlier contents audit. Recent edition moves SQL ahead of the formal design sequence.

[P3]

Cengage: Concepts of Database Management, 10th edition ↗

Friedrichsen, Ruffolo, Monk, Starks, Pratt and Last. Official publisher search results provide the nine-module outline and Access practice description.

[P4]

Pearson: Database Concepts, 10th edition ↗

Kroenke, Auer, Vandenberg and Yoder. Current publisher educator page; the uploaded PDF is the older ninth edition, not the tenth.

[P5]

Pearson: Modern Database Management, 14th edition ↗

Hoffer, Topi, Venkataraman and Bala. Official contents and description checked October 25, 2026; explicitly covers analytics, cloud and AI.

[L1]

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Data Scientists ↗

Current Occupational Outlook Handbook read October 25, 2026. Projects 35% employment growth, 2025-2035; all occupations 3%.

[L2]

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics: Database Administrators and Architects ↗

Current Occupational Outlook Handbook read October 25, 2026. Architects 9%; administrators 0%; combined 4%, 2025-2035. Rounded percentages.

[L3]

World Economic Forum: Future of Jobs Report 2025 ↗

Employer expectations for 2025-2030: analytical thinking essential to about seven in ten responding companies; AI and big data lead skills expected to grow. Global employer survey, not U.S. hiring requirements.

[T1]

PGlite: What is PGlite? ↗

Official documentation: embedded PostgreSQL compiled to WebAssembly; runs in the browser, with optional local persistence. It is not itself a hosted cloud database.

[T2]

Supabase: Database overview ↗

Official documentation: each project provides a PostgreSQL database. Hosted operations, accounts, permissions and product limits require a separate teaching plan.

[T3]

Microsoft: Get Power BI Desktop ↗

Current installation documentation, checked October 25, 2026. Windows desktop authoring creates an access requirement for Mac users.

[M1]

NCES: Undergraduate Degree Fields ↗

2021-22: 375,400 business bachelor’s degrees, 19% of bachelor’s awards. Broad audience context; degree completions are not database-course enrollments.

[M2]

Cengage: Database Systems, 15th edition, U.S. product listing ↗

Pricing retrieved October 25, 2026: eBook US$71.99 through January 22, 2027 or US$98.99 through July 21, 2027; paperback US$272.95; MindTap advertised from US$149.00. Prices and access dates can change.

[C1]

Original cover on the current book website ↗

Existing animated cover URL verified in the current repository’s HomePage component. Used unchanged, with a still-image fallback for reduced motion.